



team recently visited India. The Sports Authority of India, Public Works Department, and all other concerned departments were also available. They have submitted a report on which we are actively working. The target is to get it done by December.

"For testing, you need ammunition. We have spoken to all the companies — Lapua, Eley and RWS — who have agreed to supply ammunition regularly. The bigger

issue is the licence. We don't have the required quota for the procurement of bullets (presently, elite athletes can import 15,000 ammo at a time and carry 1,200, which is roughly equivalent to 5kg, on flights). "But the good news is that the Government has already sanctioned it.

"Now the Delhi Licensing Department has to issue it. It is already approved. I hope that we get it by this month. As soon as we get

it, we will start getting surplus batches from different companies. And once the testing facility is made, kids will be able to test it in India as well."

So, all is not lost. India's marksmen and markswomen will touch down in Japan with better ammunition than they had at the last major ISSF event. But that belies how much of their preparation has been shaped by a constraint beyond their control.